07. Windows Logon Types

1. What Is a Logon Type?

Definition: A Windows logon type indicates the kind of logon session Windows created when an account authenticated.

Logon type information is commonly found in Event ID 4624 (successful logon) and Event ID 4625 (failed logon), where available.

2. Logon Types Table

Type	Meaning	Normal Example	Suspicious Example
2	Interactive	A user signs in at the computer's keyboard	An unexpected account signs in locally after hours
3	Network	A user accesses a shared folder over the network	Repeated network logons from an unexpected host
4	Batch	A scheduled batch job runs under a service account	An unknown batch job uses an unusual account
5	Service	A Windows service starts under its configured account	An unauthorized service uses a privileged account
7	Unlock	A user unlocks an existing workstation session	An unexpected unlock occurs on an unattended device
10	RemoteInteractive	A user connects using Remote Desktop	An unknown source remotely accesses an administrator account
11	CachedInteractive	A user signs in using cached domain credentials when a domain controller is unavailable	An unexpected offline sign-in occurs on a sensitive device

3. Important Investigation Fields

When reviewing Event ID 4624 or 4625, check:

- Account name and domain.
- Logon type.
- Timestamp.
- Source IP address and workstation name, if present.
- Authentication package and failure reason, where available.
- Related logon and logoff events.

4. Important Points

- Logon type 3 does not necessarily mean Remote Desktop; it commonly represents network access.
- Logon type 5 is common when services start.
- Logon type 10 is commonly associated with Remote Desktop.
- Cached logon (type 11) can be legitimate when a domain controller cannot be reached.
- Suspiciousness depends on the account, device, time, source and normal activity.

5. Conclusion

Logon types help analysts understand how a Windows account accessed a device. Correlating logon types with accounts, timestamps and source devices can help identify unauthorized access.